Numerals, Number Words, and How Many
Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1 Counting and Cardinality

Quick Answers

1. 6	3. 9	5. 13	7. —
2. 7	4. —	6. 12	8. 16

Curriculum

Level: Kindergarten–Grade 1 Counting and Cardinality
1.NBT – *problems 5, 6, 7, 8*
K.CC.A.1–K.CC.C.7 – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4*
Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 8 tagged checks.

Common wrong answers

2. *If they got 3: counted the bundle as one mark instead of five*
6. *If they got 21: wrote the digits in the order the word is said, twenty-one style, giving 21*
8. *If they got 6: counted only the loose counters and ignored the full ten-frame*

1. Two rows of buttons — write the numeral.

Step 1. The buttons sit in two equal rows, so count the top row first and then keep counting into the second row instead of starting over.
Step 2. Top row: one, two, three — that is 3. Count on through the second row: "four, five, six". That is $3 + 3$.
Step 3. The last number said is how many, so the numeral to write is $\boxed{6}$
Listen for: a child who restarts at one on the second row. Ask "how many altogether?" and point along both rows without lifting the finger.

2. Word card *seven* with tally marks — write the numeral.

Step 1. The card, the tallies and the numeral all name one amount, so counting the tallies tells us what numeral the word *seven* is written as.
Step 2. The first bundle is five tally marks: count them, "one, two, three, four, five". Then count on for the two singles: "six, seven". That is $5 + 2$.
Step 3. The numeral that matches the word *seven* is $\boxed{7}$
Common wrong answer: 3 — the bundle of five was counted as a single mark. A bundle is five marks, not one.

3. Full five-frame and four loose counters — circle the word.

Step 1. A full five-frame is 5 without recounting — that is what the frame is for — so start at five and count on.
Step 2. "Six, seven, eight, nine" for the four loose counters. That is $5 + 4$.
Step 3. Nine counters, so the word to circle is *nine* and the numeral is $\boxed{9}$
Teaching note: the two distractor words, *four* and *six*, are the counts a child gets by reading only the loose counters or by stopping one short.

4. Card A shows 8; card B shows dots. Write $>$ or $<$.

Step 1. The two cards use different representations, so they cannot be compared until both are numbers. Card A is already a numeral: 8.
Step 2. Count card B: the five-frame is full, which is 5, and one more star makes "six". That is $5 + 1$, so card B is 6.
Step 3. Eight is more than six, so the true sentence uses the *greater than* sign: Card A $\boxed{>}$ Card B.
Listen for: "Card B is more because I can see the dots." A numeral counts exactly as much as a picture of the same amount.

5. Full ten-frame and three loose dots — write the numeral.

Step 1. The ten-frame is full, so it is 10 and does not need recounting. Count on from ten for the loose dots.
Step 2. "Eleven, twelve, thirteen" — that is $10 + 3$.
Step 3. The numeral is $\boxed{13}$
Teaching note: thirteen is "ten and three more". Saying it that way while pointing at the frame and the loose dots is the first step toward place value.

6. Word card *twelve* with a ten-frame and two more.

Step 1. The word and the picture name the same amount, so count the picture to find out how the word *twelve* is written as a numeral.
Step 2. The frame is full, so start at 10 and count on for the two extra circles: "eleven, twelve". That is $10 + 2$.
Step 3. The numeral is $\boxed{12}$
Common wrong answer: 21 — the digits were written in the order the word sounds. Teen words say the ones part first but are written tens first; the ten-frame picture is the check.

7. Sam's word card *eleven* against Nina's dots.

Step 1. One card is a word and the other is a picture, so turn both into numbers before comparing.
Step 2. Sam: *eleven* means one ten and one more, which is $10 + 1$. Nina: her ten-frame is full and four stars sit beside it, which is $10 + 4$.
Step 3. Both start from a full ten-frame, so only the extras decide. One is less than four, so Sam $\boxed{<}$ Nina.
Teaching note: comparing teen numbers by their extras is exactly how place value will be used later — same tens, so look at the ones.

8. Ben wrote 6 for a word card reading *sixteen.*

Step 1. Ben's numeral and the word card disagree, and the picture settles it. The first frame is full, so the picture already holds 10 before any of the loose dots are counted.
Step 2. Count on from ten through the second frame: "eleven, twelve, thirteen, fourteen, fifteen, sixteen". That is $10 + 6$.
Step 3. The numeral that matches the picture and the word is $\boxed{16}$
What Ben did wrong: he counted only the dots in the second frame and ignored the full frame beside it, so he wrote 6 instead of 16. Sixteen is "ten and six more", and the word itself says *six-teen.*